

HiveForce Labs

THREAT ADVISORY



ACTOR REPORT

Bluenoroff Bypasses MoTW to Target Japanese Organizations

Date of Publication

December 27, 2022

Admiralty code

A1

TA Number

TA2022319

Summary

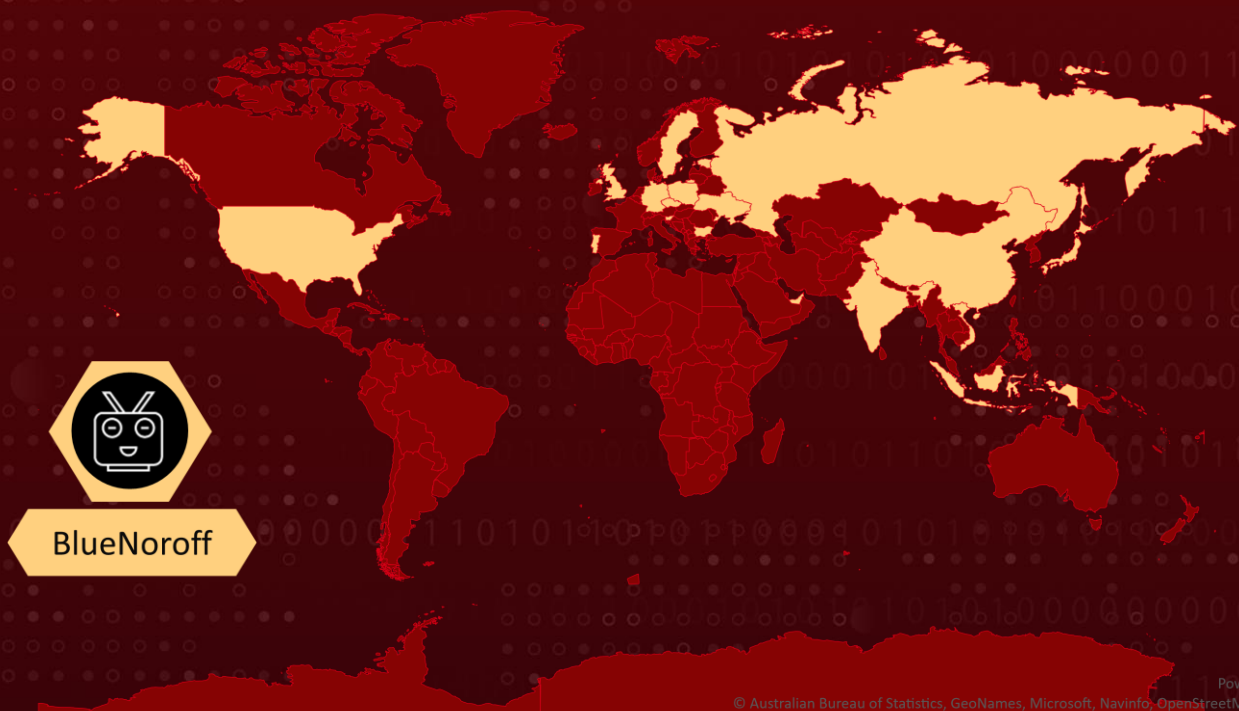
First Appearance: 2014

Actor Name: BlueNoroff

Target Region: Russia, Poland, Slovenia, Ukraine, China, India, US, Hong Kong, Singapore, the UAE, Indonesia, the UK, Sweden, Germany, Bulgaria, Estonia, Malta, Czechia, Japan

Target Sectors: Blockchains, Cryptocurrencies, Smart contracts, DeFi, and FinTech industries

Actor Map



Actor Details

#1

Bluenoroff is known for targeting financial institutions and government organizations and has been active since at least 2014. From September onwards Bluenoroff threat actors added a new feature, that bypasses the Mark of the Web (MotW) security feature in Microsoft Windows, specifically targeting Japanese organizations. MotW is a security feature that helps prevent malicious web pages from being loaded into Internet Explorer or other web browsers.

#2

The Bluenoroff group has used various tactics to bypass MotW in order to deliver malware to its targets, including using trusted third-party websites to host malicious content and using legitimate websites that have been compromised to host malicious content. The group may also use pivoted domains, which are domains that are similar to or related to existing domains, to further mimic the appearance of legitimate companies.

Actor Group

NAME	ORIGIN	TARGET COUNTRIES	TARGET INDUSTRIES
BlueNoroff (APT 38, Stardust Chollima , CTG-6459, Nickel Gladstone, T-APT-15, ATK 117)	North Korea	Russia, Poland, Slovenia, Ukraine, China, India, US, Hong Kong, Singapore, the UAE, Indonesia, the UK, Sweden, Germany, Bulgaria, Estonia, Malta, Czechia, Japan	Cryptocurrencies, smart contracts, DeFi, blockchains, and FinTech industry
	MOTIVE		
	Financial Crime		

Recommendations



Security Leaders

Phishing simulations and routine education and awareness training and communications rarely account for MFA fatigue and web browser hygiene. Integrate and communicate all lessons learned.



Security Engineers

- **Uni5 Users:** This is an actionable threat advisory in HivePro Uni5. Prioritize and block all indicators attributed to the threat actor through your Command Center. Test your controls with Uni5’s Breach & Attack Simulation.
- **All Engineers:** Refer to and action upon the ‘Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs’ & ‘Indicators of Compromise (IoC)’ on the following pages.



 Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

<u>TA0001</u> Initial Access	<u>TA0002</u> Execution	<u>TA0005</u> Defense Evasion	<u>TA0010</u> Exfiltration
<u>TA0011</u> Command and Control	<u>TA0003</u> Persistence	<u>T1071.001</u> Application Layer Protocol: Web Protocols	<u>T1041</u> Exfiltration over C2 Channel
<u>T1566.001</u> Phishing: Spearphishing Attachment	<u>T1566.002</u> Phishing: Spearphishing Link	<u>T1059.003</u> Command and Scripting Interpreter: Windows Command Shell	<u>T1059.005</u> Command and Scripting Interpreter: Visual Basic
<u>T1204.001</u> User Execution: Malicious Link	<u>T1204.002</u> User Execution: Malicious File	<u>T1547.008</u> Boot or Logon Autostart Execution: LSASS Driver	<u>T1027.002</u> Obfuscated Files or Information: Software Packing
<u>T1497.001</u> Virtualization/Sandbox Evasion: System Checks	<u>T1055.002</u> Process Injection: Portable Executable Injection	<u>T1553.005</u> Subvert Trust Controls: Mark-of-the-Web Bypass	<u>T1218.007</u> System Binary Proxy Execution: Msiexec
<u>T1218.011</u> System Binary Proxy Execution: Rundll32	<u>T1221</u> Template Injection		

 Indicator of Compromise (IOCs)

TYPE	VALUE
MD5	087407551649376d90d1743bac75aac8 f766f97eb213d81bf15c02d4681c50a4 61a227bf4c5c1514f5cbd2f37d98ef5b 4c0fb06320d1b7ecf44ffd0442fc10ed d8f6290517c114e73e03ab30165098f6 d3503e87df528ce3b07ca6d94d1ba9fc 931d0969654af3f77fc1dab9e2bd66b1 a17e9fc78706431ffc8b3085380fe29f 1e3df8ee796fc8a13731c6de1aed0818 21e9ddd5753363c9a1f36240f989d3a9

TYPE	VALUE
URLs	hxxp://avid.Inoprima[.]lol/Vclf1hLJopY/shU_pJgW2Y/KvSuUJYGoa/sX+Xk4Go/gGhl= hxxp://avid.Inoprima[.]lol/NafqhbXR7KC/rTVCTcpxPH/kMjTqFDDNt/fiOHK5H35B/bM%3D hxxp://offerings[.]cloud/NafqhbXR7KC/rTVCTcpxPH/pdQTpFN6FC/Lhr_wXGXix/nQ%3D hxxps://docs.azure-protection[.]cloud/EMPxSKTgrr3/2CKnoSNLFF/0d6rQrBEMv/gGFrolw5_m/n9hLXkEOy3/wyQ%3D%3D hxxps://docs.azure-protection[.]cloud/%2BgFJKOpVX/4vRuFlaGII/D%2BOfpTtg/YTN0TU1BNx/bMA5aGuZZP/ODq7aFQ%3D/%3D hxxps://docs.azure-protection[.]cloud/+gFJKOpVX/4vRuFlaGII/D+OfpTtg/YTN0TU1BNx/bMA5aGuZZP/ODq7aFQ%3D/%3D hxxps://bankofamerica.us[.]org/lsizTZCSlJm/W+Ltv_Pa/qUi+KSaD/_rzNkkGuW6/cQHgsE= hxxps://www.capmarketreport[.]com/packageupd.msi?ccop=RoPbnVqYd
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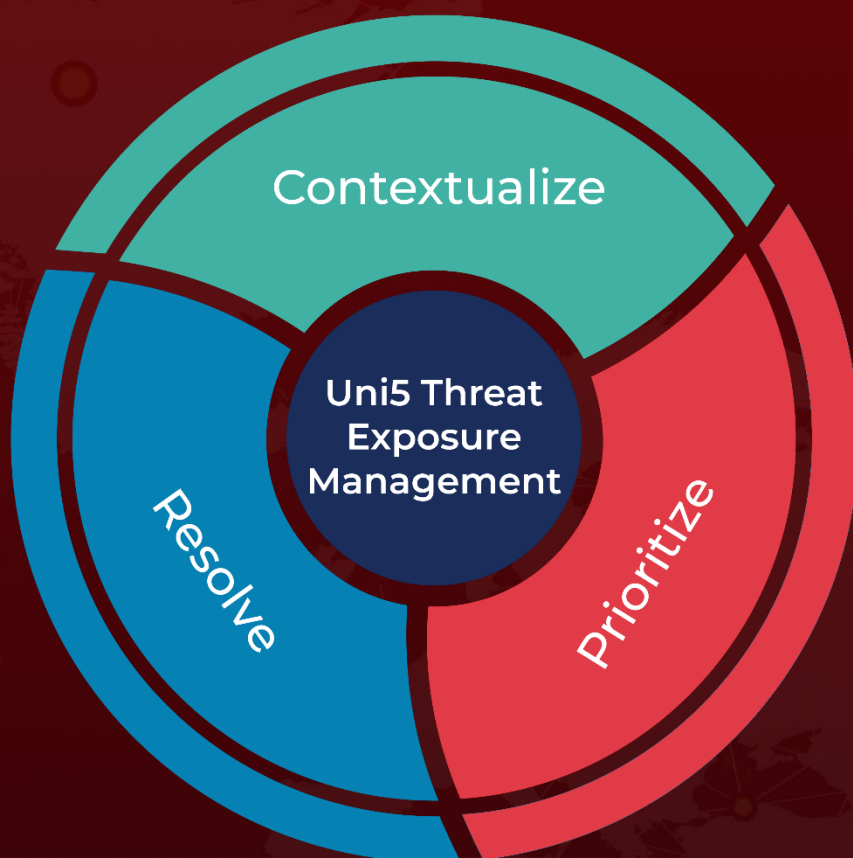
References

<https://securelist.com/bluenoroff-methods-bypass-motw/108383/>

What Next?

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Book a free demo with HivePro Uni5: Threat Exposure Management Platform.



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